



SUMMER FINANCE PROJECT

INVESTOR PSYCHOLOGY

A practical method to decide better, control impulses and invest with discipline

Fear, greed, biases, market drops, FOMO, a decision journal and an emotional execution plan.

1

Emotional clarity

2

Decision rules

3

30-day execution

Educational material. Does not constitute individual investment advice.



Editorial note and responsible use

This ebook is educational material about financial behavior and decision-making. It does not point to specific assets, does not promise returns, and does not replace a professional suitability assessment, financial planning, securities advice, tax guidance, or psychological support.

The goal is simple: help the investor turn intention into method. Most meaningful financial mistakes are not born only from lack of information; they come from a mix of emotion, haste, overconfidence, social comparison and the absence of rules written in advance.

The core promise of this material

By the end, the reader will have a practical system to reduce impulsive decisions, build personal investment rules, react better to drops, consume less financial noise, and track decisions in a structured journal.

What this guide delivers

Emotional clarity tools, checklists, decision matrices, a 30-day plan, an investor journal, and a protocol for market drops.

What this guide does not do

It does not pick assets, does not predict markets, does not guarantee results, and does not teach trading by impulse, leverage, or promises of quick gains.

How to use this ebook

This material was designed to be read and executed. A quick read helps, but the real gain comes from filling in the tools and creating rules before emotion shows up.

- | | |
|--|--------------------------|
| Read chapters 1 and 2 to understand your emotional patterns. | ☐ |
| Fill in the bias diagnostic before reviewing your portfolio. | ☐ |
| Write your personal investment policy before buying new assets. | ☐ |
| Use the anti-panic protocol on days of sharp drops. | ☐ |
| Review your decision journal once a month. | ☐ |
| Only change strategic rules on calm days, not in the middle of euphoria or fear. | ☐ |

Golden rule

Every important decision should go through a pause. A disciplined investor is not someone who never feels fear; it is someone who does not let fear sign the buy or sell order.

Visual summary

The structure follows a building logic: first understand the mind, then identify biases, create rules, test them under stress scenarios, and finally execute a practical plan.

Part	Theme	Practical takeaway
1	Investor mindset	Why emotion, risk and horizon need to talk to each other.
2	Behavioral biases	Loss aversion, confirmation, anchoring, FOMO, herding and overconfidence.
3	Decision system	Investment policy, checklists, buying, selling, rebalancing and pause rules.
4	Drops, noise and scams	How to get through difficult markets, social media, news and irresistible promises.
5	Workbooks	Investor journal, emotional score, drop checklist, contract and monthly review.
6	30-day plan	Guided execution to consolidate the method and turn behavior into routine.

How to position this material commercially

This product works very well as a complement to any investing course: it does not compete with asset analysis; it improves the student's ability to execute the plan without self-sabotage.

01

Investor mindset

Investing better is not about eliminating emotions. It is about creating a system where emotion, risk, horizon and goals share the same map.



1. Why psychology matters in investing

The investor does not decide in a vacuum. They decide with fear of losing, the desire to be right, comparison with other people, urgent news and recent memories of profit or loss. That is why investor psychology is the bridge between technical knowledge and real execution.

Technical knowledge

Helps you understand products, risk, liquidity, fees, taxes and diversification. It is necessary, but not sufficient.

Behavior

Determines whether the investor can stick to the plan when the market falls, when everyone is talking about an opportunity, or when an asset rises too much.

A simple, coherent portfolio executed with discipline can be more effective than a sophisticated portfolio abandoned at the first moment of stress.

- | | |
|---|--------------------------|
| Do I have clear goals? | ☐ |
| Do I have a deadline for each goal? | ☐ |
| Do I have a contribution rule? | ☐ |
| Do I have a selling rule? | ☐ |
| If my portfolio drops, do I know what I will do? | ☐ |
| If everyone is talking about an asset, do I have a rule against acting on FOMO? | ☐ |

2. The real investor vs. the ideal investor

The ideal investor reads reports, compares alternatives, understands probabilities and decides without rushing. The real investor feels discomfort when losing, euphoria when gaining, anxiety when watching others profit, and regret when they don't buy something that went up.

The problem is not feeling

Feeling fear or excitement is not a flaw. The problem is turning passing emotions into permanent decisions, like selling a long-term portfolio because of one bad week.

Situation	Impulsive response	Response with method
Market fell sharply	Sell everything to stop the pain	Review plan, horizon, liquidity and rebalancing
Asset rose a lot	Buy in late out of fear of missing out	Check thesis, price, risk and concentration
Negative news	Change the whole portfolio	Separate noise, new facts, and impact on goals
A friend made money	Copy the position	Understand if the asset fits your profile and plan

3. The investor's emotional curve

Market cycles tend to amplify emotions. During an upswing, the investor tends to overestimate their ability. During a downturn, they tend to overestimate the risk that everything will go wrong. The challenge is not letting the portfolio become a reflection of the month's mood.

Cycle phase	What usually happens
Optimism → Euphoria	Growing confidence pulls in more risk and more concentration.
Anxiety → Fear → Panic	The drop tests the reserve, the horizon and the conviction of the plan.
Relief → Discipline	The investor returns to the method and resumes the review routine.

During euphoria

People buy more risk because recent gains feel like proof of skill. The care needed is to avoid concentration, leverage and overconfidence.

During panic

People sell to relieve discomfort. The care needed is to tell apart a real need for liquidity, a change in fundamentals, and an emotional reaction.

Control question

If I hadn't seen today's price, would I still make this decision?

4. Stated risk profile vs. lived risk profile

Many people call themselves aggressive when the market rises and conservative when it falls. The true risk profile shows up when there is loss, a delayed goal, bad news or social pressure.

Emotional risk

Emotional risk = financial impact + social pressure + urgency + lack of a plan

Signal	May indicate
You check your portfolio several times a day	Operational anxiety or lack of a clear horizon
You change strategy after videos or headlines	Low protection against noise
You can't stand seeing a temporary drop	Portfolio misaligned with your profile, or need for a reserve
You buy assets you don't understand	FOMO, overconfidence, or blindly outsourcing judgment
You invest without knowing when you'll need the money	Poorly planned liquidity risk

My emergency reserve is separate from my risk portfolio.

☐

I know how much of the portfolio can swing without jeopardizing goals.

☐

I understand the difference between volatility and permanent loss.

☐

I know which assets do not suit me.

☐

5. The S.T.O.P. method

The S.T.O.P. method is a simple routine to stop a short-term emotion from taking over a long-term decision.

Letter	Meaning	Practical question
S	Stop	Am I deciding based on a plan or on impulse?
T	Think it through	What actually changed: price, fundamentals, timeline, goal or mood?
O	One portfolio view	Does this decision make sense with my portfolio as a whole?
P	Play it out / Proceed	What happens if I'm wrong — and is the action proportional, documented and reviewable?

Implementation rule

The more emotional the moment, the smaller the decision should be. On stressful days, prefer to review, rebalance according to your rule, or wait. Avoid irreversible decisions.

02

Behavioral biases

Biases are mental shortcuts that are useful in many areas of life, but dangerous when they replace analysis, diversification and planning.



6. Loss aversion

The pain of losing tends to be felt more intensely than the pleasure of gaining an equivalent amount. This can lead the investor to sell good assets at bad times or avoid any risk at all, even when the timeline allows for volatility.

How it shows up

Selling at the bottom to relieve the pain; keeping cash idle out of fear of any swing; checking the portfolio compulsively.

Antidote

Set an acceptable swing limit, a horizon for each goal, and a rebalancing rule before the drop happens.

What is the timeline for this money?

☐

Is the loss temporary or permanent?

☐

Did my thesis change, or just the price?

☐

Am I selling to protect a goal, or to relieve anxiety?

☐

7. Confirmation bias

Once an investor forms an opinion, they tend to seek only information that confirms their thesis and ignore contrary warnings. This makes it harder to recognize mistakes.

How it shows up

Only following analysts who agree with you; interpreting every piece of news as confirmation; avoiding negative reports.

Antidote

Create a list of evidence that would make you change your mind, and deliberately seek out the best opposing argument.

What information could prove I'm wrong?

☐

Did I read a quality opposing view?

☐

Am I confusing rooting for something with having a thesis?

☐

Is the risk priced in, or just being ignored?

☐

8. Anchoring

Anchoring happens when an initial piece of information — like a purchase price, an old price target or a historical high — dominates the analysis even after new information appears.

How it shows up

Refusing to sell because "I want to get back to my price"; buying because something looks "cheap" versus a past high, without evaluating fundamentals.

Antidote

Reassess the asset with current data, compare alternatives, and separate past price from present value.

Is my purchase price relevant to the current thesis?

☐

Is the asset cheap, or did it just fall?

☐

Has the scenario changed?

☐

Is there a better alternative for the same risk?

☐

9. Recency and availability

Recent or easy-to-recall events seem more important than they really are. A recent drop can make the investor think everything will keep falling; a recent rally can create the illusion of an endless trend.

How it shows up

Projecting last month onto the next few years; overweighting headlines; changing strategy after one striking event.

Antidote

Look at long windows, alternative scenarios, and data that matches your goal's timeline.

Am I using an appropriate horizon?	☐
Is the event structural or a one-off?	☐
What does long-term data suggest?	☐
Am I reacting to the most recent headline?	☐

10. Herd effect and FOMO

When everyone seems to be making money on a thesis, the investor feels an urge to jump in. Fear of missing out can be stronger than risk analysis.

How it shows up

Buying because "everyone is talking about it"; entering trendy themes late; increasing a position without understanding the product.

Antidote

Create a 24-to-72-hour waiting rule, limit exposure by theme, and require a written thesis before investing.

Would I buy this without social pressure?☐

Do I understand the asset?☐

What is the worst plausible scenario?☐

Does the position fit my concentration limit?☐

11. Overconfidence

A few recent wins make the investor overestimate their skill, underestimate risk, and increase turnover or concentration. Luck starts to look like method.

How it shows up

Increasing risk after gains; dropping diversification; believing you can consistently predict the short term.

Antidote

Log decisions, measure process and outcome separately, limit position sizes, and review mistakes.

Did my gain come from my thesis or from a favorable market?☐

Am I increasing risk without noticing?☐

Is my process repeatable?☐

How much could I lose if I'm wrong?☐

12. The disposition effect

It is the tendency to sell winners too quickly and hold losers too long, trying to avoid admitting a mistake.

How it shows up

Locking in a small profit to "make it safe"; holding on to a bad asset hoping it recovers; turning a trade into a long-term investment.

Antidote

Have a rule for thesis, price, quality and role in the portfolio. The central question is not whether it's in profit, but whether it still deserves to hold capital.

Would I buy this asset today?

☐

Did the thesis improve, worsen, or just did the price fall?

☐

Am I avoiding admitting a mistake?

☐

Is there an opportunity cost?

☐

13. Mental accounting

The investor divides money into "psychological buckets" that don't always make sense. They may take on excessive risk in one part and be overly conservative in another, without looking at the whole portfolio.

How it shows up

Treating profit as casino money; taking risk with "money you already won"; ignoring that everything makes up your net worth.

Antidote

Evaluate consolidated net worth, goal by goal, and total portfolio risk.

Am I looking at the whole portfolio?

☐

Is my reserve protected?

☐

Am I taking too much risk just because I profited?

☐

What goal does this asset serve?

☐

14. Status quo and inertia

Sometimes the investor doesn't err by acting too much, but by not acting when they should: not rebalancing, not cutting costs, not organizing taxes, or keeping bad products out of comfort.

How it shows up

Keeping old investments without reviewing them; postponing simple decisions; confusing patience with neglect.

Antidote

Create a monthly and quarterly review with objective criteria, not the mood of the day.

Is the product still adequate?	☐
Do the fees make sense?	☐
Has the allocation drifted from target?	☐
Am I avoiding a decision out of laziness or fear?	☐

15. Regret aversion

Fear of regret makes the investor avoid necessary decisions or look for someone else to blame. They prefer not to decide, so they don't have to be responsible for the outcome.

How it shows up

Waiting for absolute certainty; copying others to share the blame; never selling even when the thesis is broken.

Antidote

Accept that investing means deciding under uncertainty. Focus on process, probability, risk and learning.

Am I demanding impossible certainty?

☐

Am I looking for a guarantee?

☐

Which decision is more consistent with my plan?

☐

How will I evaluate the outcome later?

☐

16. Quick bias diagnostic

Use this table to identify which biases show up most in your behavior. Don't check the boxes to judge yourself; check them to build practical defenses.

Observed behavior	Likely bias	Defense
I buy when everyone is talking about it	FOMO / herding	Waiting rule + written thesis
I sell when it drops a lot	Loss aversion	Drop plan + goal timeline
I only look for favorable opinions	Confirmation	Opposing-thesis checklist
I never sell losers	Disposition / regret aversion	Broken-thesis rule
I increase risk after winning	Overconfidence	Concentration limit
I check the price constantly	Anxiety / noise	Fixed review routine
I think the old price is the reference	Anchoring	Reassess with current data

Exercise

Pick your 3 most frequent biases and write a specific rule for each. Example: "When I feel FOMO, I wait 48 hours and only buy if the thesis is written on one page."

03

Decision system

Without a rule, every headline becomes a strategy. This system turns decisions into process, not improvisation.



17. Your personal investment policy

A personal investment policy is a short document that defines goals, timeline, risk, liquidity, allocation and behavior rules. It doesn't need to be perfect; it needs to be written before emotion kicks in.

Main goal

Goal timeline

Approximate target amount

Is the emergency reserve separate?

Maximum tolerable risk

Target allocation

Allowed products

Prohibited products

Contribution frequency

Review frequency

Rule for a drop

Rule for selling

Usage tip

Keep this page and review it quarterly. Changing your rule every week is not a strategy; it is anxiety dressed up as management.

18. Checklist before investing

Before buying any asset, the investor should answer questions that protect against impulse, hype and concentration. If many answers are "I don't know," the best decision may be to study more or reduce the position size.

- | | |
|---|--------------------------|
| I understand how this investment makes and loses money. | ☐ |
| I know the main risks. | ☐ |
| I know the recommended timeline for this investment. | ☐ |
| I compared it with alternatives of similar risk. | ☐ |
| The position fits my portfolio's concentration limit. | ☐ |
| I can explain the thesis in a few sentences. | ☐ |
| I know when I would sell or reduce it. | ☐ |
| I am not buying out of haste, shame, envy or FOMO. | ☐ |
| The decision respects my reserve and my goals. | ☐ |

Practical rule

If the thesis doesn't fit on one page, maybe you don't understand it well enough yet. Complexity is not the same as quality.

19. How to write an investment thesis

A written thesis reduces the risk of rewriting the story after the outcome. It lets you compare what you thought beforehand with what actually happened.

Block	What to write
Reason for buying	Why does this asset/product enter the portfolio?
Role	Income, growth, protection, liquidity, diversification, or controlled speculation?
Risks	What events could hurt the thesis?
Limit	What will be the maximum position size?
Exit	What would make you sell, reduce, or stop contributing?
Review	When will the thesis be reassessed?

Asset/product

Class

Role in the portfolio

Central thesis

Main risks

Entry price/condition

Monitoring criteria

Exit criteria

Maximum position size

Date of next review

20. Buying rules

Buying is easy when there is excitement. That's why buying rules need to protect the investor from popular themes, seductive promises, and decisions based only on recent performance.

Planned purchase

Born from goal, allocation, analysis, price/condition and role in the portfolio. It can be repeated with discipline.

Emotional purchase

Born from urgency, comparison, news, fear of missing an opportunity, or pressure from others. It usually comes without a risk limit.

I am respecting my target allocation.	☐
I am not over-concentrating.	☐
Liquidity fits my timeline.	☐
The risk of loss is clear.	☐
This investment does not depend on a promise of quick gains.	☐
I logged the thesis in my journal.	☐

21. Selling rules

Selling can be just as emotional as buying. Selling out of panic destroys plans; never selling out of pride does too. An exit should be tied to the thesis, the risk, the goal, or rebalancing.

Reason to sell	Healthy signal	Emotional signal
Rebalancing	Asset class passed its limit	I want to lock in profit out of fear
Broken thesis	Fundamentals or rules changed	I am angry at the asset
Goal reached	Money will be used on the planned date	I want to spend on impulse
Excessive risk	Concentration got out of control	I sold because I saw a headline
Better alternative	Opportunity cost was analyzed	Switching for the trend of the moment

Final question

Would I sell this asset if it were exactly at break-even, or am I just reacting to the price I paid?

22. Allocation as an emotional shield

A good allocation is not only about seeking returns. It exists to prevent a single thesis, asset class, or headline from having the power to destroy the investor's emotional plan.

Layer	Role	Emotional mistake it prevents
Reserve	Liquidity and safety	Selling risk assets at a bad time due to lack of cash
Conservative	Stability and near-term goals	Excessive exposure to volatility
Growth	Long-term wealth	Staying out of productive assets out of fear
Income	Cash flow and partial predictability	Confusing yield with a guarantee
Satellite	Smaller theses and learning	Taking too much risk on new ideas

Principle

The portfolio should be designed for the investor's real behavior, not for a heroic version who never feels fear.

23. Rebalancing without drama

Rebalancing means bringing the portfolio back to strategy when one asset class rises or falls too much. It helps you sell a bit of what got too big and buy what got too small, according to a rule.

Trigger	What to do	Watch out for
Deviation by asset class	Compare current allocation to target	Don't rebalance every day
New contribution	Direct it to whatever is below target	Avoid unnecessary turnover
Goal change	Review timeline and liquidity	Don't confuse goal with mood
Risk change	Reduce exposure that no longer fits	Document the reason

I have a defined target allocation.

☐

I have a tolerance range per asset class.

☐

I use contributions to rebalance when possible.

☐

I avoid turning over the portfolio unnecessarily.

☐

I log rebalancing moves in my journal.

☐

24. When not to act

The ability to do nothing is also a decision. Many mistakes come from touching the portfolio when the best move would have been to wait, review, or study.

Warning sign	Recommended action
You are very angry, afraid, or euphoric	Postpone the relevant decision for 24 hours
The thesis came from a short post	Look for the primary source and understand the risks
You want to recover a loss quickly	Reduce the size of the decision and review the plan
You can't explain the product	Don't invest yet
You feel artificial urgency	Suspect a sales tactic or a scam

Protective phrase

Missing an opportunity is better than taking on a risk you don't understand.

04

Drops, noise and scams

The investor needs a plan for bad days, for social media, and for promises that seem too good to be true.



25. Protocol for market drop days

Drops are part of the market, but every drop tests three things: liquidity, horizon and conviction. The protocol below prevents discomfort from turning into a rushed decision.

- Stop checking the price repeatedly.
- Check that your emergency reserve is intact.
- Separate short-term goals from your long-term portfolio.
- Read your personal investment policy.
- Check whether fundamentals actually changed, or just the price.
- Only consider rebalancing if your rule allows it.
- Avoid selling to relieve emotion without logging the reason.

Date

What happened in the market

What I felt

What actually changed

What my plan says

Decision made

What I will review in 7 days

26. Volatility is not always permanent loss

Volatility is a price swing. Permanent loss involves real deterioration, fraud, a broken thesis, unsustainable debt, poor allocation, or a forced sale. Confusing the two can lead to bad decisions.

Question	If the answer is yes
Do I need the money in the short term?	The problem may be timeline and liquidity, not the asset
Did the investment thesis change?	Reassess the position with criteria
Is the position too large?	Reducing risk may be necessary
Am I selling out of necessity?	Reserve planning failed
Am I selling out of fear?	Apply the protocol and postpone if possible

Important

Don't romanticize drops. Some losses signal a real mistake. The point is to evaluate with method, not by reflex.

27. News, social media and noise

Too much information can create the feeling that there is an urgent decision every hour. In investing, too much unfiltered information becomes noise.

Type of content	Behavioral risk	Practical filter
Alarmist headline	Selling out of fear	Check the source, timing and impact
Quick-gain post	FOMO	Require a thesis and a risk assessment
Overly confident opinion	False authority	Look for a counterpoint
Ranking of "best assets"	Buying without suitability	Check goal, timeline and profile
Total-crisis narrative	Paralysis	Separate scenario from portfolio

I limit how often I follow the market.

☐

I have pre-defined trustworthy sources.

☐

I don't buy an asset because of a screenshot of returns.

☐

I am suspicious of urgency and secrecy.

☐

I don't confuse financial entertainment with advice.

☐

28. Scams exploit emotion

Financial scams rarely sell just a product; they sell an emotion: urgency, exclusivity, fear of missing out, trust in a group, a promise of safety, or the dream of getting rich fast.

Red flags

High returns with little or no risk, urgency to decide, payment through strange channels, secrecy, unrealistic guarantees, and social pressure.

Defense

Verify the institution, registration, documentation, risks, custodian, regulator, track record, and fit with your profile.

- The promise seems too good to be true.

☐
- There is pressure to decide today.

☐
- The person avoids explaining the risks.

☐
- The investment isn't clear or lacks enough documentation.

☐
- There is a guarantee of a high return.

☐
- The offer depends on an invite, a closed group, or a supposed secret opportunity.

☐

29. Conversations with advisors, friends and influencers

Having support can be positive, but outsourcing your judgment is dangerous. The final decision needs to fit your plan, not someone else's excitement.

Question to ask	Why it protects you
What is the main risk?	Forces the conversation out of the sales pitch
In what scenario does this lose money?	Tests the honesty of the analysis
What is the right timeline?	Avoids using the wrong product for a short-term goal
What costs and taxes are involved?	Shows the net impact
How does this fit my portfolio?	Avoids an isolated product with no strategy
What would change your mind?	Reduces confirmation bias

Rule

Don't buy something just because a smart person bought it. They may have a completely different timeline, net worth, information, risk tolerance and goals than you do.

30. The investor's emotional routine

A routine reduces improvised decisions. The goal is not to follow the market less out of ignorance, but to follow it better, with intention.

Frequency	Action
Daily	You don't need to check your portfolio if your horizon is long. Consume less noise.
Weekly	Log contributions, relevant news, and strong emotions.
Monthly	Update net worth, income, contributions, and emotional score.
Quarterly	Review allocation, goals and deviations.
Yearly	Review investment policy, taxes, goals and risk profile.

- I have a fixed review day.

☐
- I don't make big decisions outside my review without a real reason.

☐
- I log my emotion before buying/selling.

☐
- If I'm anxious, I reduce the size of the decision.

☐

05

Workbooks and tools

Theory becomes protection when the investor writes, measures, reviews, and learns from their own decisions.



31. Investor journal

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

Date
Decision made
Stated reason
Dominant emotion
Confidence level 0-10
Perceived risk
What could go wrong
Source of the idea
Position size
Future review

32. Monthly emotional score

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

Month
How many times did I check my portfolio unnecessarily?
How many purchases were planned?
How many decisions came from news or social media?
Biggest emotion of the month
Mistake avoided
Mistake made
Rule to improve

33. Purchase log

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

Asset/product
Class
Role in the portfolio
Why now?
Risks
Loss limit or broken-thesis point
Information source
Alternatives analyzed
Initial size
Condition to increase

34. Sale log

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

Asset/product
Reason for the sale
Did the thesis change?
Did the goal change?
Did the risk change?
Was it rebalancing?
Dominant emotion
What I learned
What will the money be reallocated to?
Review date

35. Monthly portfolio review

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

Total net worth
Contribution this month
Passive income this month
Current allocation
Target allocation
Relevant deviations
Decisions made
Decisions postponed
Emotional learning
Next objective action

36. Market-drop plan

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

5% drop: what I will do
10% drop: what I will do
20% drop: what I will do
Assets I can add to
Assets I don't understand well enough
Forced-sale limit
Person/professional to consult
Phrase I will read before acting

37. Pre-commitment contract

Fill in this table before or after decisions, depending on the tool's purpose. Logging reduces self-deception and improves the quality of future reviews.

I commit to not buying out of FOMO
I commit to not selling out of panic without reviewing my plan
I commit to logging important decisions
I commit to respecting my reserve
I commit to reviewing mistakes without punishing myself
Signature
Date

38. Family financial conversation

When family, a partner, or dependents are involved, a financial decision can also be emotionally shared. Aligning expectations prevents conflict and impulsive decisions.

Main financial goal

Fears of each person

Risk limits

Liquidity needs

What we will not accept doing

How we will decide on changes

How we will react to a drop

Family review frequency

Attention

Investing should not become a test of courage. Emotional safety, clarity and consensus matter more than looking sophisticated.

06

30-day plan

A short plan to turn awareness into routine, focused on clarity, rules, protection against noise, and review.



39. 30-Day Plan - Week 1

The first week is dedicated to diagnosis. The goal is to understand how you decide before trying to improve the portfolio.

Day	Mission
1	List all your investments and goals.
2	Separate reserve, short-term, medium-term and long-term.
3	Fill in the bias diagnostic.
4	Identify the 3 emotions that most affect your decisions.
5	Review purchases made due to outside influence.
6	Write down what you no longer want to repeat.
7	Do a calm review and pick 3 priority rules.

I did not make an impulsive purchase this week.

☐

I logged my main biases.

☐

I separated money by goal.

☐

I identified sources of noise.

☐

40. 30-Day Plan - Week 2

The second week turns diagnosis into a personal investment policy. The goal is not to shuffle the portfolio much, but to build rules.

Day	Mission
8	Define goals and timelines.
9	Describe your lived risk profile, not just your stated one.
10	Create a target allocation by layer.
11	Set concentration limits.
12	Write down allowed and prohibited products.
13	Define drop and rebalancing rules.
14	Review your personal policy and keep a copy.

Success criterion

By the end of the week, you should know what you buy, why you buy it, how much you buy, when you review, and when you don't act.

41. 30-Day Plan - Week 3

The third week is dedicated to decisions. You will create filters for new purchases, selling rules, and information hygiene.

Day	Mission
15	Create a checklist before investing.
16	Create a one-page thesis template.
17	Review a current position using the written thesis.
18	Define a selling rule.
19	Define an information routine and trustworthy sources.
20	Remove or mute sources that cause anxiety or FOMO.
21	Do a weekly review without buying anything on impulse.

I have a buying checklist.

☐

I have a selling rule.

☐

I have information limits.

☐

I wrote at least one complete thesis.

☐

42. 30-Day Plan - Week 4 and wrap-up

The final stage consolidates routine and crisis preparation. The investor should come out with a simple system to follow in the coming months.

Day	Mission
22	Fill in the market-drop plan.
23	Create an anti-scam checklist.
24	Review the portfolio for concentration.
25	Review liquidity by goal.
26	Build a monthly dashboard.
27	Write your pre-commitment contract.
28	Review past mistakes without guilt.
29	Set a quarterly review schedule.
30	Write the final version of your personal method.

Expected result

You will not have control over the market. But you will have more control over process, decision size, noise, impulses and consistency with your goals.

43. 90-day continuity plan

After the 30 days, the goal is to repeat the process until it becomes routine. Investor psychology is not content to read once; it is a system to keep alive.

Period	Focus
Days 31-45	Use the journal for every relevant decision.
Days 46-60	Review allocation and concentration without rushing.
Days 61-75	Improve information routine and reduce noise.
Days 76-90	Compare decisions made against defined rules.
Every quarter	Update your policy, goals, and emotional score.

What improved

Biggest mistake avoided

Biggest impulse noticed

Most useful rule

Rule that needs to change

New commitment

44. Frequently asked questions

Question	Practical answer
Does feeling fear mean my portfolio is wrong?	Not necessarily. But constant fear can indicate excessive risk, lack of a reserve, or absence of a plan.
Should I stop following the news?	No. But you should filter source, frequency, and relevance to your goals.
Is it wrong to sell at a loss?	No. What's wrong is selling without criteria. Sometimes a sale acknowledges a broken thesis; sometimes it's panic.
How do I know if I have FOMO?	When the urgency comes more from social comparison than from your own analysis.
Does the journal really help?	It helps reduce self-deception and separate a good decision from a short-term outcome.
Can I change my strategy?	Yes, but ideally in a calm moment, with written criteria, not during euphoria or panic.

45. Financial behavior glossary

Term	Meaning
Bias	A systematic tendency in judgment that can distort decisions.
Heuristic	A mental shortcut used to simplify decisions.
FOMO	Fear of missing out on a perceived opportunity.
Loss aversion	The tendency to feel losses more intensely than equivalent gains.
Anchoring	Fixation on initial information, even when new evidence appears.
Rebalancing	An adjustment to bring the portfolio back to its defined allocation.
Thesis	A rational, documented justification for holding or buying an asset.
Noise	Information that creates anxiety but does not improve the decision.
Suitability	How well a product fits an investor's profile, goal, timeline and risk capacity.

46. Commercial positioning page

This ebook can be sold as a standalone product or as a complement to a broader financial learning track. It is especially useful for students who already know concepts like fixed income, REITs, ETFs, dividends and taxes, but still struggle to execute consistently.

Product	How to position it
Investing from Scratch: The Method	A base manual for organizing your financial life and learning asset classes.
Smart Fixed Income	A deeper look at safety, liquidity, and comparing products.
Dividends and Passive Income	An educational look at building recurring income, without promising guarantees.
REITs from Scratch	A deeper look into real estate investment funds.
ETFs and Global Investing	International diversification and a passive strategy.
Investor Psychology	Emotional execution, discipline, and decision-making.

Sales pitch

The investor doesn't just need to know where to invest; they need to know how not to sabotage themselves when the market tests their patience.

47. Technical references and sources

The references below were used as an educational foundation to build a responsible approach to behavior, investor protection, and financial decision-making.

Source	Contribution to this material
CVM - Behavioral Finance Series (Brazil)	Publications on the biases of investors, savers, and consumers.
Investor Portal / CVM (Brazil)	Financial education, care when investing, and strategies to reduce cognitive biases.
CFA Institute	Classification and discussion of investors' cognitive and emotional biases.
SEC / Investor.gov	Fraud alerts, warning signs of guaranteed-return promises, and investor protection.
FINRA Foundation	Research and materials on investor behavior, risk, scams, and financial education.
Central Bank of Brazil	Financial education, money organization, and decision-making.

Reference links: gov.br/investidor; gov.br/cvm; investor.gov; sec.gov; finra.org; cfainstitute.org; bcb.gov.br.

Final notice

Rules, taxes, and financial products can change. Before making financial decisions, check official sources and assess your profile, goals, timeline, liquidity and risks.

48. Closing

Investor psychology is not about being cold, invulnerable, or able to predict the market. It is about the humility to recognize that everyone is subject to biases, and the discipline to build barriers against impulsive decisions.

A portfolio that's perfect on paper won't hold up if the investor doesn't survive the first emotional test. That's why the best method is one that combines technical knowledge, clear goals, risk management, and repeatable behavior.

Final message
Don't try to beat the market every day. Try to beat your most expensive impulses. That alone is already a huge edge.

- I have a written personal policy.

☐
- I have rules for buying, selling and rebalancing.

☐
- I have a protocol for drops.

☐
- I have a decision journal.

☐
- I have a monthly review routine.

☐
- I know which emotions affect me the most.

☐

End of volume: Investor Psychology.